

ADINO

INTERNAL STRATEGY DOCUMENT

Core Product Loop

Version 1.0

Part 1 of 3

What Adino Fundamentally Is · Why Traders Return Daily
What Emotional Problem It Solves · What Operational Dependency It Creates

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HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

This is Part 1 of a three-part internal strategy series. It is not a roadmap. It is not a feature list. It is a diagnostic — a precise description of the repeating human behavior that Adino must own if it is to become indispensable to Nigerian traders.

Everything in this document is grounded in two sources: the actual Adino codebase as audited in May 2026, and the behavioral realities of Nigerian SME operators as documented in the accompanying market research. Observations about the current product — both strengths and weaknesses — are drawn from code, not assumption.

The question this document answers: What is the repeating daily behavior that makes a Nigerian trader open Adino, feel immediate value, and come back again tomorrow — without being told to?

Section 1 — Core Product Philosophy

What Adino fundamentally is. What emotional problem it solves. What behavior it reinforces daily.

1.1 What Adino Fundamentally Is

Adino is not a point-of-sale system. That description is accurate but insufficient. A POS records transactions. Adino's job is larger: it is a trust infrastructure for a trader who operates in a fundamentally untrustworthy environment.

Every day, a Nigerian shop owner faces three betrayals that compound silently. Their staff takes without recording. Their customers take on credit and delay repayment. Their stock disappears without explanation. Each betrayal is individually small. Collectively, they are the reason the money never adds up at the end of the week.

The trader knows this is happening. They do not have the tools to stop it, measure it, or prove it. They operate on instinct, memory, and suspicion. This is an exhausting and expensive way to run a business.

Adino is the tool that replaces instinct with evidence. Not reports, not charts, not dashboards — evidence. Proof that a sale happened. Proof of what was paid. Proof of who was at the counter. Proof that the stock should be at a certain level.

This framing has a specific implication: the core product is not the POS terminal. The core product is the record. The POS terminal is just the fastest, most frictionless way for that record to be created.

1.2 The Job the Trader Is Hiring Adino to Do

Clayton Christensen's Jobs-To-Be-Done framework asks: what progress is the customer trying to make in their life? For a Nigerian shop owner, the answer has two layers — one operational, one emotional. Both must be understood because the emotional job determines whether the trader opens the app at all.

Without Adino — the trader's daily reality	The job Adino is hired to do
<i>"I think I made about ₦45k today. Or maybe ₦40k. I am not sure."</i>	Know the exact number. Not at month-end. Tonight, before the generator goes off.
<i>"My cashier said the customer only bought two items. But I think it was three."</i>	Have a record that is timestamped, tied to a cashier name, and impossible to dispute.
<i>"Mama Kemi owes me from last month. I am embarrassed to ask again."</i>	Have formal proof of the debt. Remove the awkwardness from the collection conversation.
<i>"I ran out of Peak Milk on Friday and found out only when a customer asked."</i>	Know before it happens. Not after the customer has already walked to a competitor.
<i>"I work every day but the bank says I have no business records for a loan."</i>	Accumulate transaction history that becomes the only formal proof of income the trader has ever had.

The operational job is "record this sale quickly and accurately." The emotional job is "help me feel like I am in control of my own business." Both must be satisfied on every interaction. A product that handles the operational job without the emotional one will be used once and abandoned. A product that handles the emotional job without the operational one will be loved but not depended on.

The emotional job is primary. If the trader does not feel safer and more in control after using Adino, no feature completeness will save it.

1.3 What Behavior Adino Must Reinforce Daily

The behavior that Adino must make habitual is the act of recording at the moment of transaction. Not later. Not from memory. Not approximated. At the moment the money changes hands.

This is a harder behavior change than it appears. The current default for most traders is to record nothing, or to record into a book at the end of the day from memory. That default is deeply entrenched, socially reinforced (every other trader in the market does the same thing), and feels safer than a digital record that might attract attention from tax authorities.

For Adino to win, recording a sale must become more automatic and less effortful than not recording it. That means the POS must be faster than the notebook. The receipt must be more satisfying than tearing off a paper stub. And the reward for recording — the daily summary number, the shift accountability, the proof of income — must be visible and meaningful to the trader within 24 hours of their first recorded sale.

The moment Adino becomes faster to use than the notebook is the moment the habit forms. Everything before that moment is friction reduction. Everything after that moment is value amplification.

Section 2 — Core Product Loop v1

The five stages of the repeating daily behavior. Each stage is described at two levels: what the trader experiences, and what the product must deliver.

This is not a user journey map. It is a description of the loop that must run at least once per trading day for Adino to have value. If any stage breaks, the loop breaks, and the trader defaults back to their notebook.

Stage 1 — Trigger

What naturally causes the trader to open Adino?

The trigger must be external and automatic. It must not require the trader to remember that the app exists. It must be generated by the ordinary rhythm of their working day — not by a notification, not by a nudge, not by a prompt from the app.

For the Cashier, the trigger is a customer standing in front of them with money. The transaction is the trigger. The POS is the tool they reach for. This trigger is already habitual in shops that have adopted any form of digital recording — the challenge is making Adino the tool they reach for instead of whatever they currently use.

For the Owner, there are two natural triggers:

- Morning opening — "What happened yesterday? What is the cash float today?" The owner opens the app to see the previous day's total before the first customer arrives.
- Evening closing — "How much did I make today? What does my cashier owe me?" The owner opens the app before the safe is counted.

Both of these triggers are currently satisfied by Adino in a limited way. The dashboard shows today's revenue and a comparison to yesterday. The shift summary tracks the cashier's session. But neither trigger is being actively reinforced by the product. The app does not send a morning summary. It does not prompt end-of-day reconciliation. The owner must remember to open it. That is a structural weakness.

1 TRIGGER	
Cashier trigger	A customer presents money or asks for an item. The POS must be the fastest path to completing the transaction.
Owner trigger (AM)	Opening the shop. "What happened yesterday? What should today look like?" The app should have an answer waiting.

Owner trigger (PM)	Closing the shop. "How much did I make? What does my cashier owe me?" The app should produce the number without navigation.
What strengthens it	A WhatsApp message to the owner at 8am with yesterday's total. This creates a trigger that works even if the owner never opens the app voluntarily.
Current state	Cashier trigger: strong. POS loads quickly, search is fast, offline works. Owner trigger: weak. No automatic morning summary. No closing prompt. Owner must choose to open the app.

Stage 2 — Core Action

What is the single most important repeated action?

The core action is: search for a product, add it to the cart, and confirm payment. That sequence is the heartbeat of the product. Everything else — onboarding, settings, reports, sync — exists to support and protect that sequence.

The sequence currently takes between 8 and 25 seconds in the Adino POS, depending on the number of items. That is competitive with a manual notebook transaction and significantly faster than a ledger book. The search-first interface is well-suited to a trader who knows their products by name. The colour avatars for imageless products make the grid scannable.

However, the core action has two friction points that must be addressed before the loop can run reliably at scale:

- The first time a cashier opens the POS on a new session, they must clock into a shift before selling. This is correct from an accountability standpoint but creates a moment of confusion. The clock-in modal must be instant and familiar, not bureaucratic.
- The payment confirmation step requires the cashier to select a payment method. The most common Nigerian scenario — cash — should be one tap, not a selection from a modal. The current keyboard shortcut (C for cash) is excellent but invisible to new users.

The offline path deserves specific recognition. A sale that completes offline — receipt printed, cart cleared, queue updated — is behaviorally indistinguishable from an online sale to the cashier. That invisibility is the product working correctly. The "PENDING SYNC" label on the receipt is the only visible difference, and it communicates reliability rather than failure.

2 CORE ACTION	
The sequence	Search product → tap to add → adjust quantity → confirm payment → receipt generated. Must complete in under 15 seconds for a single-item sale.

Offline behaviour	Identical to online from the cashier's perspective. Receipt shows "pending sync" label. Sale is queued and will upload on reconnection. This is correct and must never regress.
Current strength	POS search is fast. Product grid is scannable. Payment modal is clear. Offline path is invisible. Keyboard shortcuts exist for speed.
Current friction	Clock-in modal on first sale of the day adds a step. Cash payment requires opening a modal rather than a single tap. C shortcut is undiscoverable.
What the action creates	A timestamped, cashier-attributed, payment-method-tagged record that cannot be altered retroactively. This is the evidence layer. Every sale creates one.

Stage 3 — Immediate Reward

What instant relief or value does the trader feel?

The immediate reward is the most psychologically important stage of the loop. It is what makes the action feel worth doing in the moment, before any cumulative value has been built. It must be felt within 3 seconds of the core action completing.

For the cashier, the immediate reward is the receipt. A clean, professional receipt — with the store name, the items, the total, the payment method, the cashier's name, and a receipt number — is a signal of legitimacy. The customer sees it and trusts the transaction. The cashier sees it and knows the record exists. In Nigerian commerce, a receipt is not just a record. It is a status signal. It says: this is a real business.

For the owner, the immediate reward is the session counter visible in the POS header. "N47,500 · 12 sales this session" — that number updating in real time as each sale completes is a source of genuine pleasure. It is the equivalent of watching the meter run. It answers the question "is today a good day?" without requiring any navigation.

The receipt is not a functional document. It is an emotional one. The cashier who hands a printed or digital receipt to a customer feels more professional than one who tears off a paper stub. That feeling of professionalism is the immediate reward for recording the sale. Design everything around reinforcing it.

The current Adino receipt is technically correct — it shows the right information in a clean thermal format. What it lacks is warmth. It does not say "Thank you" in a way that is culturally resonant. It does not give the customer anything to remember the shop by. A WhatsApp share button on the sale confirmation screen would transform the receipt from a document into a conversation opener between the shop and the customer.

3 IMMEDIATE REWARD	
For the cashier	A clean, professional receipt appears immediately. The cart clears. The app is ready for the next customer. The transaction is done. No doubt. No dispute.
For the owner	The session counter updates in real time. The owner watching remotely (or present at the counter) sees the number grow. This is the dopamine signal of a trading day going well.
The trust signal	Every receipt is timestamped, numbered, and tied to a cashier name. The first time an owner uses a receipt to resolve a dispute with a customer or a cashier, the product's value becomes permanent in their mind.
Current strength	Receipt format is professional. Offline receipt correctly labels pending sync. Session revenue counter is visible in POS header.
What is missing	No WhatsApp share on the receipt screen. No sound or animation on sale completion (the feedback loop is silent). No "good day" signal when the owner's session total crosses a threshold.

Stage 4 — Stored Value

What compounds over time and makes Adino harder to abandon?

Stored value is what converts a useful tool into an indispensable one. It is the accumulation of data, records, and history that would be painful to lose and impossible to recreate. The longer a trader uses Adino, the more it costs them to leave.

The primary stored value in Adino today is transaction history. Every sale creates a permanent record: what was sold, to whom (payment method), when, by which cashier, on which shift, at what price. After 30 days of consistent use, the owner has a month of business data that no notebook has ever given them. After 90 days, they have a quarterly picture. After 180 days, they have the only formal proof of business income that most Nigerian traders will ever possess.

The secondary stored value is the product catalogue. A trader who has uploaded 200 products with names, prices, and categories has invested significant time. That investment is a switching cost. Moving to a competitor means re-entering 200 products from scratch. Combined with the image compression and colour avatar work done in the last engineering sprint, the product catalogue is now a meaningful stored asset.

The tertiary stored value — not yet built — is the customer credit ledger. Once "owe me" tracking is implemented, every outstanding debt becomes a record that the trader cannot afford to lose. A customer who owes ₦12,000 across eight transactions is a financial relationship that only exists in Adino. Walking away from the app means walking away from that record.

4 STORED VALUE	
Layer 1 — Transaction history	Every sale adds to a permanent, searchable, exportable record. 30 days of data is useful. 180 days is a loan application. This is the most powerful stored value and it compounds automatically with no action from the trader.
Layer 2 — Product catalogue	A 200-product catalogue with prices, images, and categories represents hours of setup investment. Switching costs grow linearly with catalogue size.
Layer 3 — Staff accountability record	Every shift creates a record of who was at the counter and what they sold. After 60 days, an owner has a performance history for every cashier. This is irreplaceable.
Layer 4 — Customer debt ledger (not yet built)	Once "owe me" is implemented, outstanding customer balances become the highest-value stored asset. A trader will not abandon an app that holds their receivables.
What weakens stored value today	No export or backup UX. If the owner's phone dies and they lose access, recovery is unclear. The stored value must be visible — a "you have 847 sales on record" display would make the cost of leaving tangible.

Stage 5 — Return Trigger

Why does the trader reopen Adino later that day or tomorrow?

The return trigger is the mechanism that closes the loop. Without it, Adino is used once per transaction and then forgotten until the next transaction occurs naturally. With it, the trader actively wants to reopen the app between transactions — to check, to verify, to see the number grow.

There are three natural return triggers for a Nigerian trader, and Adino currently satisfies only the weakest one:

Return Trigger 1 — The Closing Number (Currently Weak)

At the end of the trading day, the owner wants to know one number: how much did I make today? The current Adino dashboard shows this number, but the owner has to navigate to it. It is not pushed. It is not automatic. It requires the owner to remember that the app has the answer.

The fix is straightforward: an end-of-day WhatsApp message, sent automatically at a time the owner configures (default 8pm), with today's total, top-selling product, and any pending sync items. This single feature transforms the return trigger from passive to active.

Return Trigger 2 — The Cashier Check (Currently Moderate)

An owner who suspects a cashier is not recording all sales will reopen the app during the day to check the session total. "There have been 8 customers in the last two hours. My app shows 5 sales. Where are

the other 3?" This is a powerful return trigger because it is driven by suspicion, which is a constant emotional state for many Nigerian shop owners.

The current shift session counter in the POS header partially satisfies this. The owner can see the total. What they cannot currently do is compare "sales during this cashier's session" against "estimated traffic." That comparison — even as a rough count — would make the return trigger much stronger.

Return Trigger 3 — The Stock Warning (Currently Missing)

A low-stock alert is a return trigger with real commercial urgency. "Indomie is down to 3 units" is a message that makes the owner open the app, verify the stock level, and take action (call the supplier, restock from the back). It is also a message that, if sent via WhatsApp, requires no app open at all — the trader acts from the message.

This trigger is not yet built. It is Sprint 2 work. But it is worth naming here because it is the return trigger with the highest behavioral leverage: it creates a direct connection between Adino's visibility function and a real monetary outcome (not losing a customer because of empty shelves).

5 RETURN TRIGGER	
Trigger 1 — Closing number	Owner wants to know today's total before counting the cash. Currently: must remember to open app. Future state: WhatsApp message at 8pm pushes the number automatically.
Trigger 2 — Cashier check	Owner suspects discrepancy between customer traffic and recorded sales. Currently: session total visible in POS header but no comparison view. Partially satisfies this trigger.
Trigger 3 — Stock warning	Low-stock alert sent via WhatsApp when a product drops below a configurable threshold. Not yet built. Highest urgency return trigger because it is connected to immediate revenue loss.
Trigger 4 — Debt reminder	Once "owe me" is built: a weekly WhatsApp message listing outstanding customer balances. Creates a return trigger that is also a collection tool.
Current state	Return triggers are almost entirely passive. The trader must choose to return. The product does not pull them back. This is the most significant structural weakness in the current loop.

Section 3 — Initial Strategic Insight

What the true Adino product is. What makes the loop potentially sticky. What the current MVP already does well. What currently weakens the loop.

3.1 What the True Adino Product Actually Is

The POS terminal is the acquisition mechanism. The record is the product.

This distinction matters because it changes every product priority. If the POS is the product, then the goal is making transactions faster and more feature-rich. If the record is the product, then the goal is making the record more valuable, more visible, more trustworthy, and harder to leave behind.

The record has three faces:

- For the cashier: proof that they did their job. A shift record that shows every sale, every payment method, every item. If something goes wrong — a missing item, a disputed payment — the cashier can point to the record and say "I recorded it correctly."
- For the owner: intelligence about their business. Not just revenue, but patterns. Which cashier sells more. Which products move fastest. Which payment method customers prefer. Which days are slow. None of this is available from a notebook.
- For the trader's future: a financial identity. Six months of Adino records is the beginning of a credit history. That is the long-term moat — not the POS, not the features, but the accumulation of proof that this business exists and is worth lending to.

The most important thing Adino will ever do for a Nigerian trader is help them get their first loan. Everything else is useful. That is transformative. Build every feature with that destination in mind.

3.2 What Makes the Loop Potentially Sticky

Three factors make this loop structurally sticky — meaning that once formed, the habit becomes self-reinforcing rather than requiring ongoing motivation from the trader:

Factor 1 — The Accountability Ratchet

Every sale recorded creates an expectation that the next sale will also be recorded. Once a cashier knows their sessions are tracked, they are implicitly aware that an unrecorded sale creates a visible gap in the record. The owner does not need to watch. The record watches. This is a behavioral ratchet: once the accountability system is established, reverting to no recording is psychologically uncomfortable for both the cashier and the owner.

Factor 2 — The Sunk Cost of the Catalogue

A trader who spends 3 hours importing their product catalogue has made a real investment. The product must acknowledge this investment explicitly. A "You have 247 products on record" display on the dashboard turns a sunk cost into a visible asset. The trader who sees that number does not want to re-enter 247 products into a competitor's app.

Factor 3 — The Irreplaceability of the Record

After 90 days of use, the transaction history in Adino cannot be recreated from any other source. The notebook does not have it. Memory does not have it. Only Adino has it. At the point where the record becomes irreplaceable — where losing it would be a genuine business loss — switching cost becomes prohibitive. The product must reach that point within the first 90 days for any tenant.

3.3 What the Current MVP Already Does Well

This section is grounded in the actual codebase audit. These are genuine strengths, not aspirations.

Loop Stage	What the current code does well
Trigger	POS loads quickly. Search is fast. Offline detection is implemented. Products load from IndexedDB on connectivity loss. The cashier trigger fires reliably.
Core Action	Offline sale path is invisible to the cashier — behaviorally identical to an online sale. Idempotency prevents duplicate sales. Stock decrement is atomic (race condition fixed in audit). The core action is reliable.
Immediate Reward	Receipt is professional and correct. Session revenue counter updates in real time. Receipt labels pending sync clearly without alarming the cashier.
Stored Value	Transaction history accumulates automatically. Shift records tie every sale to a cashier. Product catalogue with bulk import

	reduces setup friction. IndexedDB + sync queue means records survive connectivity loss.
Return Trigger	Dashboard shows today's revenue vs yesterday with a trend indicator. Session counter visible in POS. These are passive but functional return triggers.

3.4 What Currently Weakens the Loop

These are the structural gaps — not cosmetic issues, not minor bugs, but gaps that prevent the loop from becoming self-reinforcing. Each one has a named consequence for the trader's daily experience.

Weakness	Loop Stage Affected	Consequence for the trader
No automatic return trigger	<i>Return Trigger</i>	The owner must choose to open the app. Most will not open it unless they have an active transaction or a specific question. The loop does not close itself.
No WhatsApp touchpoint at any stage	<i>Return Trigger + Immediate Reward</i>	WhatsApp is the trader's operating system. A product that never speaks WhatsApp is a product that lives in a separate, lower-priority mental space.
No "owe me" credit tracking	<i>Stored Value</i>	The debt ledger is the highest-stickiness stored value. Without it, the record is incomplete — the trader must maintain a parallel system for credit customers, undermining Adino's claim to be the single source of truth.
VAT applied to all tenants by default	<i>Immediate Reward → breaks trust</i>	A trader who sees 7.5% VAT on a receipt for goods they sell informally feels exposed and lied to. This is a trust-destroying discovery that happens at the most emotionally positive moment of the loop.
Return triggers are passive	<i>Return Trigger</i>	The trader receives no signal from Adino between sessions. No morning number. No evening summary. No alert. The product is silent when it should be speaking.
Shift stats in CashierDashboard are hardcoded	<i>Core Action → breaks accountability</i>	CashierDashboard shows hardcoded values (₦45,000, "03:45 Hrs") instead of live shift data. An owner who checks this page to verify a cashier's session sees fabricated numbers. This is a critical credibility failure.
Currency displays as USD by default	<i>Immediate Reward → breaks trust</i>	A Nigerian trader who opens the app and sees USD pricing does not feel that this product was built for them. Trust is

		established in the first 30 seconds of use and broken in the same window.
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3.5 The Loop Visualised

The five stages of the Core Product Loop, as they run today versus how they must run at full strength:

Stage	Current (MVP May 2026)	Target (Loop at Full Strength)
1 · Trigger	Customer stands at counter. Owner opens app voluntarily.	Customer stands at counter. 8am WhatsApp pulls owner in before the first customer.
2 · Core Action	Search → add → pay. Fast. Offline-transparent. Correct.	Same — plus one-tap cash confirm. Plus "owe me" as fourth payment method.
3 · Immediate Reward	Receipt generated. Cart clears. Session counter updates.	Same — plus WhatsApp share button. Plus sale-complete sound on mobile. Plus warmth in copy.
4 · Stored Value	Transaction history + product catalogue + shift records.	Same — plus customer debt ledger. Plus "847 sales on record" display. Plus export to PDF.
5 · Return Trigger	Owner must remember to open app. Passive.	Evening WhatsApp summary. Low-stock alert. Weekly debt balance. Active triggers that close the loop.

3.6 The One Sentence This Document Reduces To

Adino wins when a Nigerian trader opens the app every morning because it has something valuable to tell them — and returns every evening because it is the only place that knows exactly what happened in their shop today.

Every engineering decision, every design decision, every copy decision between now and the 500th paying tenant should be evaluated against that sentence. Features that make it more true belong in the next sprint. Features that do not should wait.

The loop described in this document is not a theory. The core of it is already built. The offline-first architecture, the shift accountability system, the atomic stock decrement, the session counter — these

are real, working, tested components of a product that could change how Nigerian traders run their businesses.

What is missing is the emotional connective tissue. The morning message. The WhatsApp receipt. The "owe me" tab. The closing number pushed to the owner's phone. These are not features. They are the signals that tell a busy Nigerian trader: Adino is paying attention to your business even when you are not looking at the screen.

That is the product. Build toward it.